2026 Bloomberg Global Trading Challenge



The Trader's Handbook

Bloomberg

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Welcome Challengers!

The ***Global Trading Challenge*** is the only investment simulation that takes place entirely within the Bloomberg Terminal℠.

Last year, more than **2,600** teams participated in the challenge, generating **65,000+** trades, and a profit of **$20+ million.**

Over the next 5 weeks, you'll get a chance to use real–world, real-time financial tools to develop an *investment strategy*, research *high-potential stocks* and put those theories to the test to prove your trading skills!





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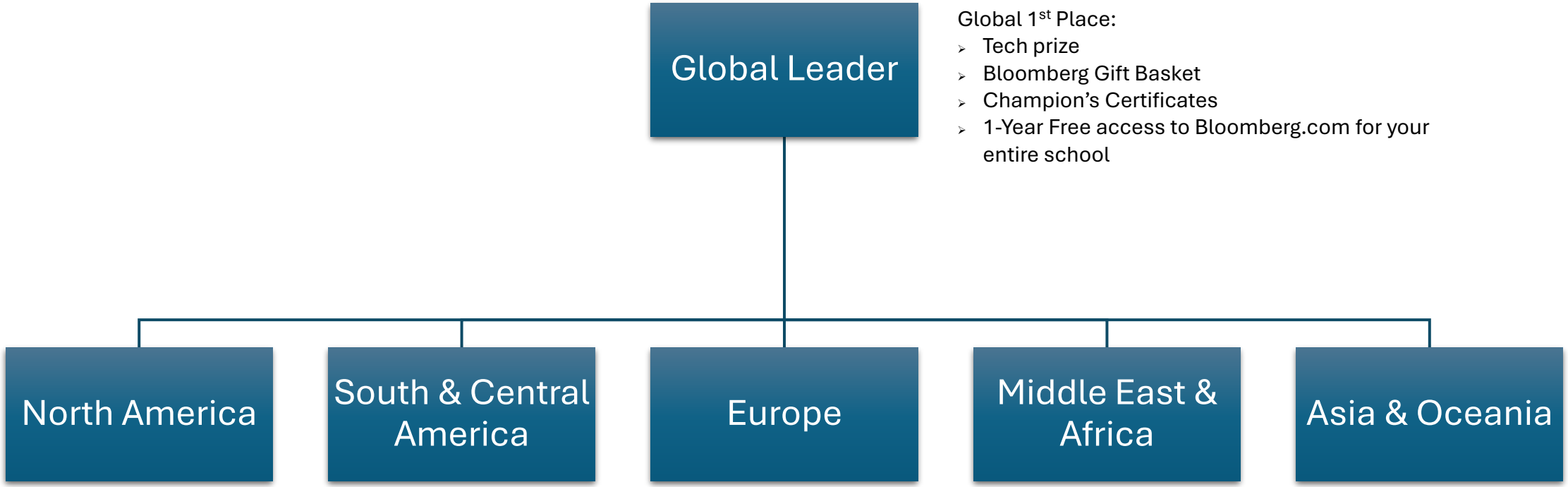
How do we Participate?

- Teams consist of 3-5 participants + faculty advisor
- $1M USD to invest
- Long-only positions and No leverage
- No single stock can make up more than 20% of your investments
- Investible Universe: WLS Index (Bloomberg World Large, Medium & Small-cap Index), offers over 10K stocks from around the world

Your team will enter your trades into the Bloomberg terminal and monitor your performance in real-time. We will send out weekly leaderboards to track your progress and how you rank against your peers.

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Winner Prizes!



Global 1st Place:
- Tech prize
- Bloomberg Gift Basket
- Champion's Certificates
- 1-Year Free access to Bloomberg.com for your entire school

Regional Winners:
- Champion's Certificates
- 6-Months Free access to Bloomberg.com for your entire school

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Important Dates:

Challenge Begins!

After registration closes, we'll send training resources to the teams to help get you ready.

Oct 12th

Oct 19th

Week 1 Results

During the Challenge, you'll be able to see your team's position in the overall rank, but the team names will be hidden. Each **Monday**, we'll release the leader boards.

Week 2 Results

By now you should have a feel for what works. You can buy-and-sell stocks as the challenge progresses.

Oct 26th

Nov 2nd

Week 3 Results

Keep at it! Keep reviewing your portfolio and keep reviewing the news. If something isn't working, should you keep it? Should you take profit?

Week 4 Results

The final countdown begins! Make that final push and connect with your team to align on ideas.

Nov 9th

Nov 13th

Week 5: Challenge End

Last and final trading day! The challenge ends on this Friday so this is the opportunity to make any final trades, take profit and line up for a photo finish!

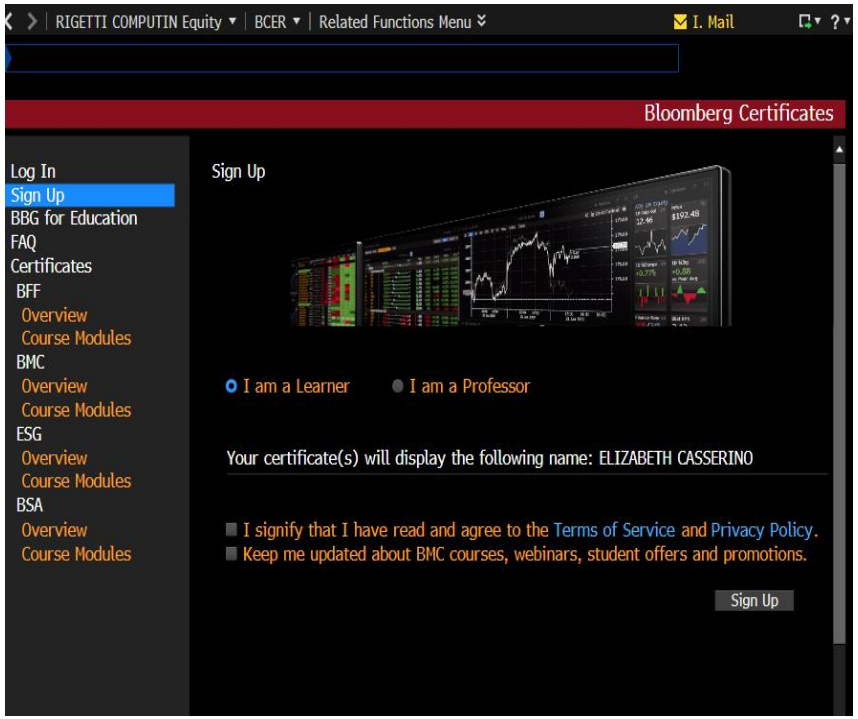
Winners Announced!

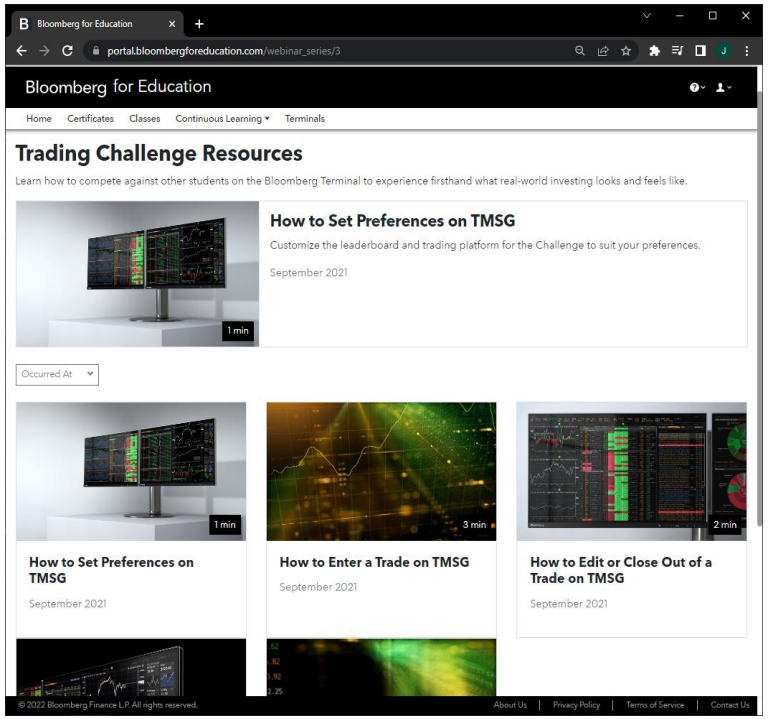
Nov 20th

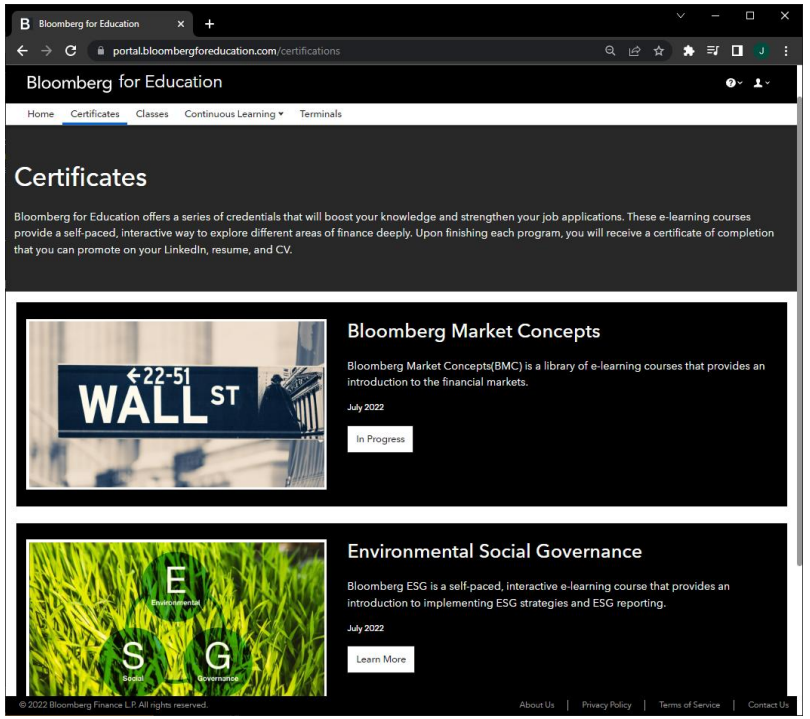
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Resources

We have a range of video resources in the *Bloomberg for Education* Web Portal. Here's how to find them:







Visit {BCER <GO>} on your terminal

Click "Continuous Learning" for Webinars

Click "Certificates" for the Bloomberg Market Concepts

Bloomberg

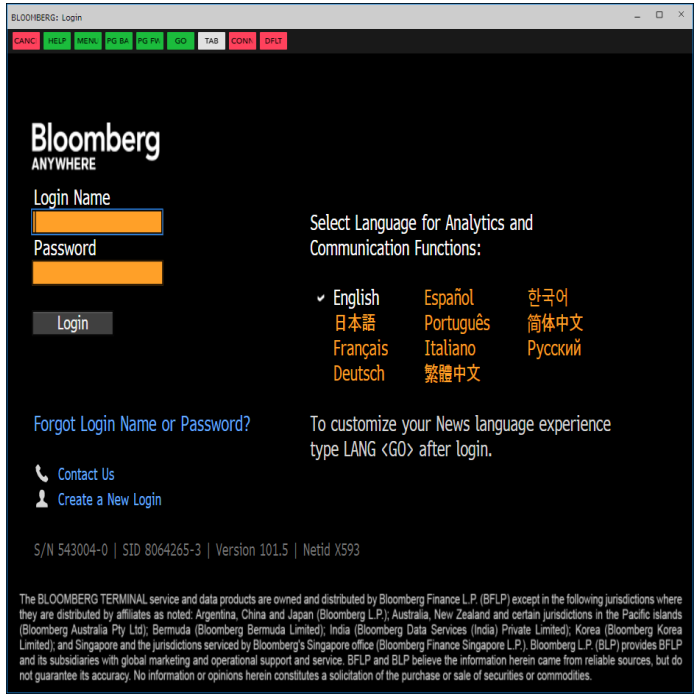
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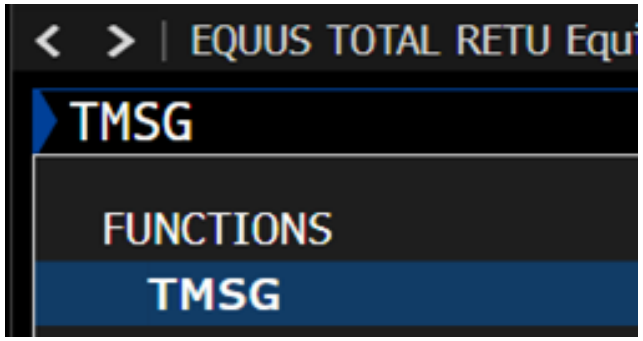
Entering Trades

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Getting Started with TMSG <GO>

In each team, only the captain enters trades, after discussing with the team what to *Buy* or Sell.







1. Login to the Terminal

2. Run TMSG <GO>

3. Select your Regional Challenge Network from the drop down

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Navigating TMSG <GO>

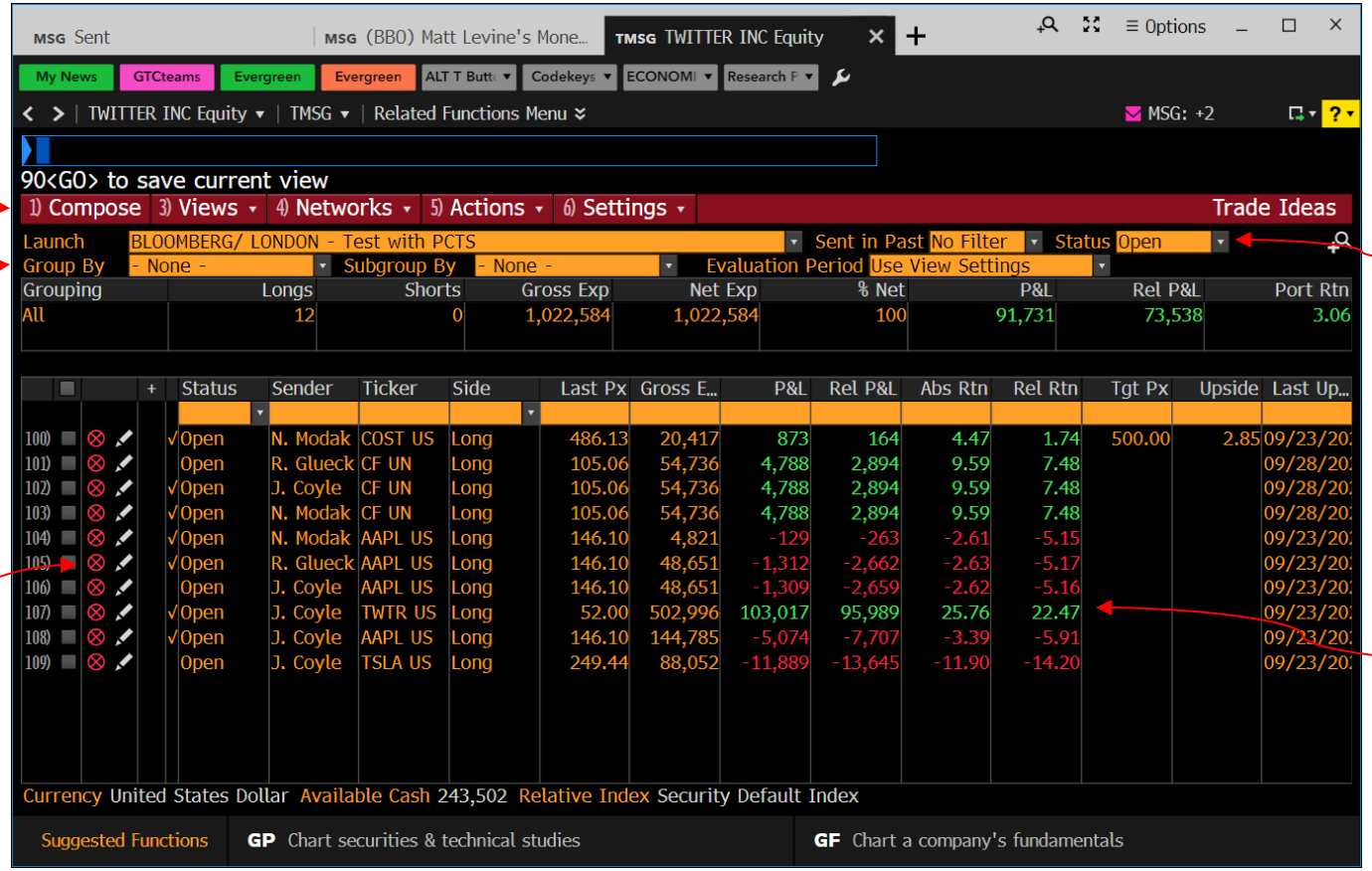
You'll enter your trades using the screen **TMSG** <go>
Some trades will do well, others not so well - TMSG sums these up and presents a total P&L for the individual trader.

TMSG also produces Profit & Loss numbers compared against the benchmark. The win criteria for the challenge is the ***Rel P&L*** column.

1) Compose a new Trade

"Group By" allows us to roll-up individual trades into baskets to see overall P&L

(X) Close an existing Trade



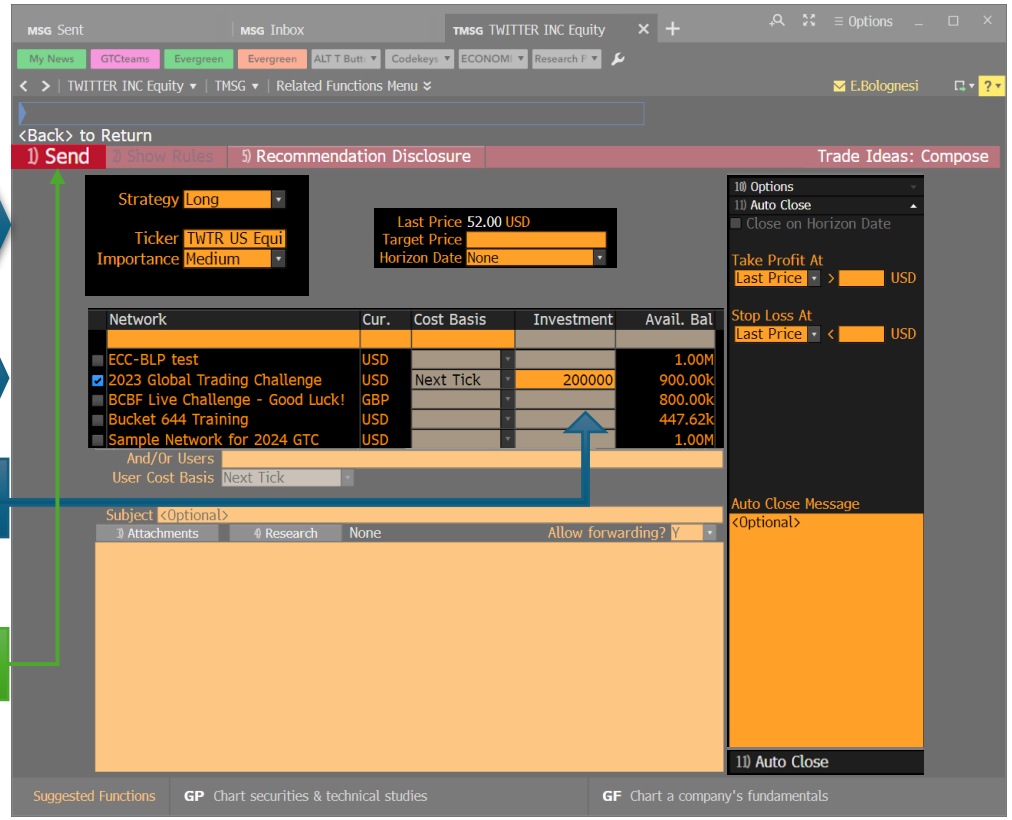
Show / hide closed trades

P&L both Absolute and Relative to the Index.

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1. Compose a new BUY trade



1. Enter your Stock here
2. Check-off the Challenge Name
3. Specify your investment in $$$
4. Click 1) Send to Complete

(*Optional*) "Target Price" is your estimated future price

These settings will automatically sell your position once the price hits a certain level. The position will close and your cash balance will increase.

(*Optional*) Click this to set Stop Loss/ Take Profit levels

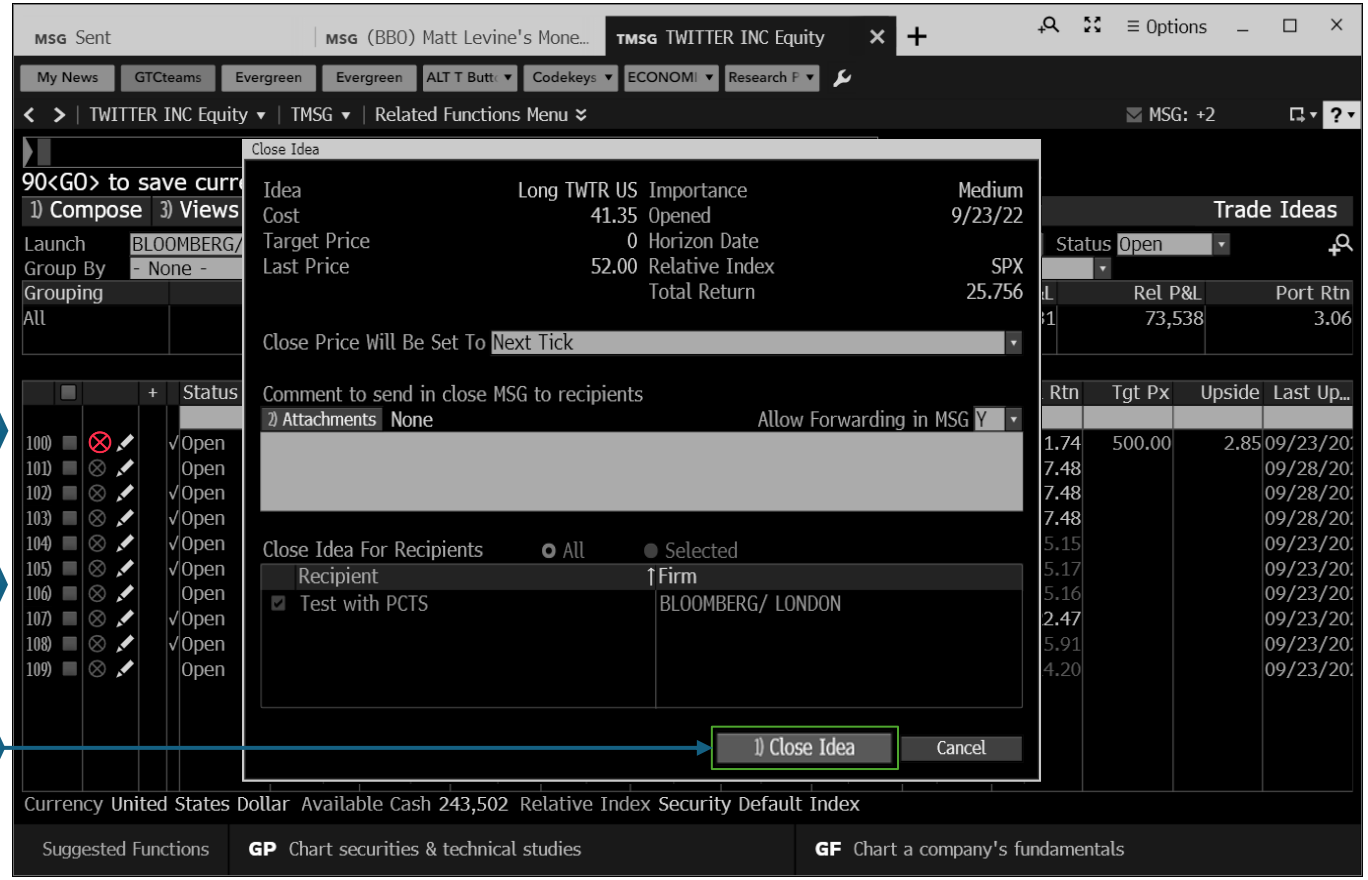
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2. Closing a trade (Selling)

1. Click the red ❌ next to the position

No need to adjust anything - will slow close.

2. Click **Close Idea**



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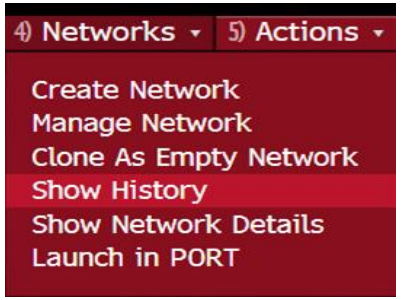
3. Seeing the “Audit Trail” of Trades

It’s sometimes helpful to understand the exact amounts that are being spent/received from the Buy and Sell trades. You can see the ledger in the 4) NETWORKS > Show History menu.

“**Debit**” items = cash spent to buy stocks
“**Credit**” items = cash received from sale of stocks

You’ll notice that when you enter a Buy order of $100k, the debit is never *exactly* $100,000. This is because TMSG tries to buy the maximum number of stock units with the money you allocated. Because stock prices vary, it never sums up to *exactly* the full amount. It should be very close.

You’ll also notice that during the 20 minutes it takes to execute a trade, the cash has not yet been posted to the ledger. It will in due course.





Date	Description	Ticker	Debit	Credit	Balance	Margin
01/01/70 01:00	Closing				243,502	0
09/23/22 14:03	Opening				1,000,000	0
09/23/22 14:30	Open	TSLA US Equity	99,941		900,059	0
09/23/22 14:30	Open	AAPL US Equity	149,859		750,200	0
09/23/22 14:30	Open	JPM US Equity	99,982		650,217	0
09/23/22 14:30	Open	LCID US Equity	149,996		500,221	0
09/23/22 14:30	Open	TWTR US Equity	399,979		100,243	0
09/23/22 15:00	Open	AAPL US Equity	49,960		50,283	0
09/23/22 15:02	Close	LCID US Equity		144,813	195,095	0
09/23/22 15:03	Close	JPM US Equity		98,355	293,451	0
09/28/22 14:30	Open	CF UN Equity	49,948			0

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4. Rules and Errors

There are a number of rules of the competition that TMSG will enforce automatically.

If you try to submit a trade that breaches one or more of the rules you'll be presented with an error message similar to this:

What it says	What it Means
"Max # Sell ideas is 0"	You've tried to enter a SHORT trade. *Please correct the strategy dropdown to "Long"*
"Minimum Cash Balance is 0"	You don't have enough cash to complete this trade. *Try to reduce your Investment amount.*
"Index Membership"	The company you want to buy is not part of the Bloomberg World Large, Medium & Small index (WLS). *Try a different company.*
"Maximum Position Size as a Percentage"	You can only invest a maximum of $200,000 into any one company. *Try to reduce your Investment amount.*

There are other possible errors; if you see one that isn't listed, contact the helpdesk at:

bbgtradecomp@bloomberg.net

It's helpful to take a screen grab with the GRAB<GO> command which will help us to diagnose the cause.



Tips For Success

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Teamwork makes the Dream Work

01	They Work *Together*	Decide early on what each team member is going to do and how you'll make decisions. It's easy for one passionate person to overrule the team, but winning teams are built on compromise and shared decisions.
02	They make an Investment Strategy, and *stick to it*.	Develop a clear process for deciding what you're going to invest in with reasons. Have frequent meetings to review the portfolio, and think how to apply your strategy to changing market conditions.
03	They understand that *Timing is Critical*	Remember, the challenge is time-limited: A strategy that needs 1 year to pay-off won't win the game. Use all the resources available on the terminal to monitor market sentiment, themes and trends.
04	They know that *tough times don't last, tough people do.*	In 2021, only 1 of our top-10 teams was on the leaderboard in first week. As markets move, strategies start to pay off and teams will move up (and down!) the rankings change rapidly. Keep at it!

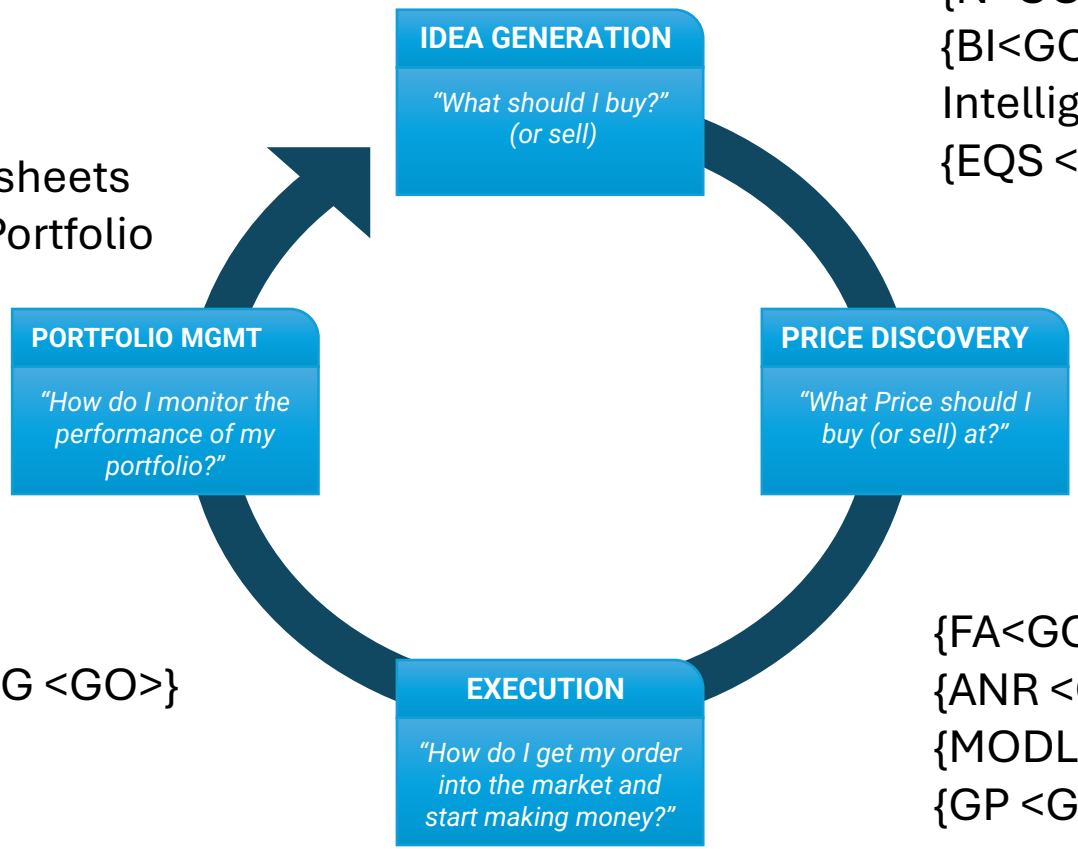


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Learn the Investment Management Cycle

{N<GO>} : NEWS
{BI<GO>} : Bloomberg Intelligence Industry Research
{EQS <GO>} : Equity Screening

{W <GO>} : Monitor Worksheets
{PORT <GO>} : Test your Portfolio



{FA<GO>} : Financials
{ANR <GO>} : Analyst Recommendations
{MODL <GO>} : Model Estimates
{GP <GO>}: Charting

{TMSG <GO>}

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Understand Relative P&L

In the Challenge, we'll be ranking teams based on your **Relative P&L**. You'll see this column in the **TMSG<GO>** blotter screen, and near to it **P&L.** What's the difference?

The important thing to remember is that you're being *measured against the benchmark*. This means that your trades don't just have to make money; they have to make *more money* than the benchmark index. For this reason, you can have a **positive P&L**, but a **negative Relative P&L.** And vice-versa, if the benchmark is doing badly.

The benchmark we're using in the challenge is the *Bloomberg World Large, Medium & Small Cap* index ("WLS Index") which you'll recognise as being the list of stocks which you're allowed to invest in.



Notice here that the **P&L** is still going up (white line) but the benchmark is going up faster (orange line). This means that the **Relative P&L** is negative, even whilst the portfolio as a whole was making money.

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Know your Help Resources

F1
Help

For questions about using the Bloomberg Terminal, each screen has a detailed Help Page that you can access by pressing the Green <Help> key on your keyboard.



For questions about financial theory, calculations and concepts, check in with your Faculty Advisor.



For questions about the Challenge, its rules, using TMSG, or anything in this guide please contact:
bbgtradecomp@bloomberg.net

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Good Luck Trading!

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